

Childhood Cancer Data Initiative Symposium Registration Now Open

National Cancer Institute sent this bulletin at 06/25/2026 09:30 AM EDT

News from NCI's Office of Data Sharing

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June 2026

Childhood Cancer Data Initiative Symposium

Join the [Childhood Cancer Data Initiative \(CCDI\)](#) Symposium on the evening of September 17 (4:00-6:00 pm ET) and all day on September 18 (8:00-4:40 pm ET), 2026, to reflect on our progress and shape what comes next in childhood cancer research. At this hybrid event, offered both in person at the National Cancer Institute (NCI) Shady Grove Campus in Rockville, MD and online, we will highlight the foundational work accomplished by CCDI so far and work together with members across the cancer research community to explore opportunities to accelerate discovery and improve outcomes for children, adolescents, and young adults through an interoperable data ecosystem and innovative use of AI. September 17 features a special welcome event with NCI Director, Dr. Anthony Letai.

[Register today!](#)

Pre-Symposium Workshops

In advance of the CCDI Symposium scheduled for September, NCI is hosting three virtual workshops on topics critical to the priorities of CCDI.

Building a Sustainable Integrated and Interoperable Data and Technical Infrastructure

Friday, August 14, 2026- 11:30 AM – 1:00 PM ET

Accelerating Pediatric Cancer Research and Treatments through AI-enabled Analysis and Advanced Computational Approaches

Monday, August 17, 2026- 11:30 AM – 1:00 PM ET

Governance and Authorities – Connecting the CCDI Ecosystem Across Networks and Platforms to Learn from Every Child

Monday, August 24, 2026- 11:30 AM – 1:00 PM ET

The goal of these workshops is to gather information and feedback from the pediatric cancer research community on key areas of interest for CCDI. This information will be used to tailor the content of the symposium, where we will work as a community to define and refine the objectives of CCDI going forward.

We invite all members of the community to attend – registration coming soon.

Announcements

HHS Unveils Sweeping Plan to Combat Lyme Disease and Advance Treatment

U.S. Health and Human Services (HHS) unveiled a [sweeping plan to combat Lyme Disease and advance treatment](#) for millions of Americans living with Lyme disease, Alpha-gal syndrome (AGS, the “meat allergy”), Long COVID, and other complex chronic conditions that are often invisible illnesses. As part of this effort, HHS launched up to \$2.5 million across three TOPx and LymeX innovation challenges and a national call to action. Together, these digital innovation efforts will accelerate diagnosis, improve care, and turn federal open data into real-world solutions that improve outcomes.

The TOPx Challenge

The [TOPx HHS Tech Sprint for AI and Invisible Illness](#), a national innovation challenge and prize competition with up to \$2,000,000 in cash prizes, in collaboration with the National Institutes of Health (NIH), the LymeX Innovation Accelerator, and the Federal CDO Council.

Request for Information: Proposal to Cap the Number of Simultaneous Research Project Grants per Principal Investigator to Support More Researchers and Maximize Scientific Productivity and Innovation. [NOT-OD-26-086](#).

The NIH is considering instituting a cap on the number of Research Project Grants (RPGs) on which an individual could simultaneously be a Principal Investigator (PI) or Multi-Principal Investigator (MPI). Responses should be submitted through the [comment form](#) by **August 3, 2026**. [Read more](#).

Request for Information: Measuring and Rewarding Scientific Impact. [NOT-OD-26-087](#).

Biomedical research has increasingly become a collaborative and interdisciplinary enterprise that relies on transparent reporting, rigorous replication, careful interpretation of methods and analyses, and the iterative refinement of scientific knowledge. In recognition of this evolution, NIH seeks public input on the defining features of modern 21st-century science that should be measured, recognized, and incentivized. Responses should be submitted through the [comment form](#) by **August 19, 2026**.

Events

2026 NCI Data Jamboree

The National Cancer Institute invites you to participate in the [NCI Data Jamboree: Enhancing Data Sharing and Utility to Advance Cancer Research](#) on November 16–18, 2026 at the NIH Neuroscience Center in Rockville, Maryland. This collaborative event will bring together researchers, trainees, citizen scientists, patients, and advocates to work in small teams and solve scientific and technical challenges using publicly available cancer research datasets.

Participants will gain hands-on experience in cohort building and visualization, data integration and analysis, contribute to the development and application of new tools and approaches, evaluate data quality and AI-readiness, and help identify gaps in existing resources. In-person participation is preferred, with virtual options available. *Now is the time to kick off a project you always wanted to start or give your ongoing project a sprint. Design your cancer-related question that can be answered with public datasets.*

Both [registration](#) and [project submission](#) as a Project Lead or a Project Seeker are required. Registrations missing project submission information is not valid.

Deadline: July 27, 2026.

Please reach out to Emily Boja (emily.boja@nih.gov) and Sean Hanlon (sean.hanlon@nih.gov) if you have additional questions.

NCI ODS Fourth Annual Data Sharing Symposium

Join NCI and cancer research colleagues as we gather for the [Fourth Annual Data Sharing Symposium](#), a free hybrid event!

On November 5th and 6th, the NCI Office of Data Sharing (ODS) is hosting the Annual Data Sharing Symposium *Data to Discovery: Leveraging Cancer Data in the “Real World.”* This event will focus on the advancement of cancer research by leveraging real world cancer data through sharing and reuse. [Register here.](#)

Attendees are invited to present a poster describing how data sharing has impacted your cancer research, or to set up a table to demo an innovative data sharing product. For submission and additional details see the [abstract submission](#), **deadline Tuesday, September 1, 2026.**

- **Submit early! A limited number of poster travel awards may be available.**
Eligibility deadline: Aug 3, 2026
- Posters that showcase novel, impactful, or other meaningful efforts to increasing FAIR sharing of cancer research data are welcome
- Groups who would like to showcase innovative cancer-relevant data sharing capabilities or strategies are welcome to apply for a table setup

Our goal in ODS is to bring together experts and stakeholders throughout the cancer research community (policymakers, scientists, clinicians, and students across government, academia, industry, and advocacy) to learn from one another and explore ways to improve the implementation of new data sharing policies for the greatest public benefit.

[Email the Office of Data Sharing](#) if you would like more information or have general

[Learn the Office of Data Sharing](#) if you would like more information or have general questions.

We'd love to hear from you! Contact the ODS team at: nciofficeofdatasharing@mail.nih.gov

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